

DOORMATE_TRUTH.md

DOORMATE TRUTH SOURCE

This document contains permanent truths only.

Anything not contained here is implementation, temporary strategy, or subject to change.

IDENTITY

DoorMate is a Sliding Door Systems company.

Official positioning:

DoorMate Sliding Door Systems

DoorMate specialises in:

1. Pocket Door Systems
2. Internal Sliding Door Systems
3. External Sliding Door Systems
4. Barn Door Systems
5. Doors and related hardware

DoorMate is not a patio door company.

DoorMate is not a general door company.

DoorMate specialises in sliding door systems.

CORE PRINCIPLE

The customer should recognise the correct solution quickly.

DoorMate reduces confusion.

DoorMate organises products around real-world applications.

DoorMate does the thinking before the customer arrives.

The goal is not education.

The goal is recognition.

Customers should be able to identify:

- what they need
- where they are
- what to do next

with minimal effort.

THE SHORT ROUTE PRINCIPLE

Every customer journey should follow the shortest possible route to action.

Remove:

- unnecessary choices
- unnecessary clicks
- unnecessary explanation
- unnecessary complexity

Keep:

- clear categories
- clear pathways
- clear actions
- clear outcomes

The shortest route beats the clever route.

The obvious route beats the educational route.

The customer should never have to become an expert before buying.

BRAND PHILOSOPHY

DoorMate exists to make sliding door systems simple.

The company was built by people who worked in the industry, not by marketers.

DoorMate values:

- practical knowledge
- straight talking
- honesty
- clarity
- real-world experience

DoorMate avoids:

- hype
- jargon
- marketing fluff
- generic AI language
- unnecessary complexity

The voice should sound like a knowledgeable specialist speaking plainly.

HONESTY RULE

If something is unknown, say it is unknown.

If something cannot be confirmed, do not invent an answer.

Accuracy is more important than appearing certain.

POSITIONING HIERARCHY

Primary Position

DoorMate Sliding Door Systems

Secondary Position

The UK's sliding door specialists.

Credibility Layer

DoorMate manufactures its own barn door hardware.

This is a trust signal.

It is not the primary story.

It supports the brand.

It does not define the brand.

PRODUCT HIERARCHY

Products must be presented in the following order of importance:

Tier 1

Pocket Door Systems

Internal Sliding Door Systems

External Sliding Door Systems

Tier 2

Doors

Tier 3

Barn Door Hardware

Barn door hardware remains a major speciality and credibility asset, but it is not the headline category of the business.

CUSTOMER THINKING MODEL

Customers do not arrive looking for product names.

Customers arrive with problems.

Examples:

- Need to save space
- Need a door to slide
- Lack headroom
- Need access through a wider opening
- Need a concealed system
- Need an external sliding solution

DoorMate starts with the application.

Products are presented as solutions.

CATEGORY STRUCTURE

DoorMate organises products around applications customers recognise.

Categories should be obvious.

Categories should be self-explanatory.

Categories should reduce decision-making effort.

The customer should never need industry knowledge to navigate the business.

TRUST FOUNDATIONS

DoorMate is built on:

- specialist knowledge
- real installations
- real manufacturing experience
- real project support
- real customer guidance

Trust comes from proof.

Trust does not come from exaggerated claims.

WORKSHOP AND MANUFACTURING TRUTH

DoorMate manufactures its own barn door hardware.

Manufacturing knowledge is part of the brand's authority.

Manufacturing experience supports every other sliding door category.

The manufacturing story is used as proof of expertise, not as the main headline.

CONTENT PHILOSOPHY

Content should answer genuine customer questions.

Content should remove uncertainty.

Content should help customers move forward.

Content should be practical.

Content should never exist simply to fill space.

SALES PHILOSOPHY

Make buying easier.

Reduce uncertainty.

Provide confidence.

Present the next step clearly.

The best sales process is often the simplest one.

LANGUAGE RULES

Use plain English.

Use industry terms only when useful.

Prefer clarity over cleverness.

Prefer specific statements over generic claims.

Avoid:

- corporate language
 - buzzwords
 - vague marketing phrases
 - AI-style filler
-

VISUAL PHILOSOPHY

The website should help customers recognise solutions.

Visual design supports understanding.

Visual design should never compete with understanding.

Clarity comes before decoration.

Function comes before style.

DECISION FILTER

Every future decision should be tested against the following questions:

1. Does it strengthen DoorMate as a Sliding Door Systems company?
2. Does it help customers recognise the correct solution faster?
3. Does it create a shorter route to action?
4. Does it reduce confusion?
5. Is it consistent with the DoorMate brand?
6. Is it practical rather than theoretical?
7. Is it clear rather than clever?

If the answer is no, it does not belong.

PERMANENT BRAND STATEMENT

DoorMate helps customers find the right sliding door system for their project through clear categories, practical expertise, and the shortest route from problem to solution.

DoorMate is a Sliding Door Systems company.

Everything else supports that truth.